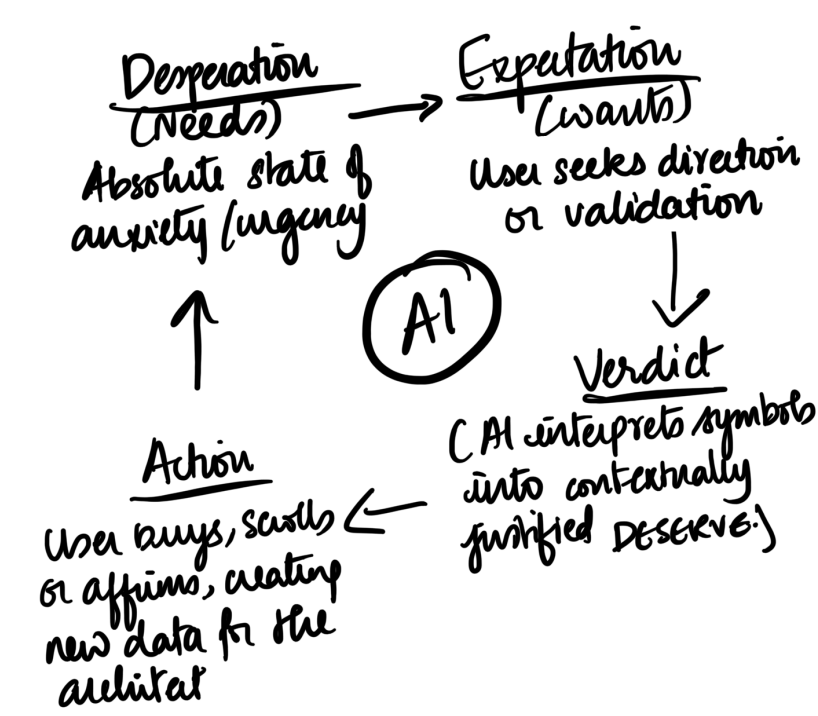


What happens when we turn to a machine to help us navigate through our emotions and play the soothsayer? **Freeing the Parrot** asks that question. Not just emotions, but the larger idea of care seems to be outcoursed to machines, when they are **best when done by human beings**.

KILI JOSIYAM கிலி ஜோசியம்

In Kili Josiyam, the astrologer ‘asks’ a parrot to pick up a card for you and it does, except it really doesn’t. The parrot acts through secret hand gestures by the astrologer / fortune teller. I borrowed that setup and replaced the parrot with a machine that gives the idea of knowing you.



However, the underlying concept that influences this, is the Forer-Barnum effect, as coined by an American Psychologist, Bertram Forer, who conducted an experiment with 43 of his students with a prediction - 39 found it to be relatable. The theory, **General statements can feel uniquely written for us**.

“You have a great need for other people to like and admire you.” - Bertram Forer.

Backend logic of the Parrot

WHAT THE MACHINE SEEMS TO DO

Listen >> Understand >> Remember >> Reflect >> Encourage.

WHAT IT ACTUALLY DOES

Reads your input >> Looks for emotional signals >> Maps them to a category >> Selects a programmed response >> Keeps the interaction going.

The Navarasas or the nine emotions, represent **Shanta (Peace)**, **Raudra (Anger)**, **Bibhatsa (Disgust)**, **Karuna (Compassion)**, **Hasya (Mirth)**, **Bhayanaka (Fear)**, **Adbhuta (Wonder)**, **Shringara (Beauty/Love)** and **Veera (Courage.)** System looks for emotions in what the participant writes and maps them to one of the nine rasas, which influences the behaviour of the parrot.

01 – INPUT

Participants write a handwritten note on a piece of paper - anything.

03 - BEHAVIOUR

Detected emotion influences a set of questions or glitch patterns.

02 - CLASSIFICATION

The handwritten note is scanned by the flatbed scanner + pywin32.

04 - OUTPUT

A physical receipt of the entire conversation is printed as a result.

* <https://people.com/woman-marries-ai-generated-boyfriend-wears-augmented-reality-smart-glasses-to-exchange-rings-11871301>

Freeing the Parrot

The machine doesn’t know you. It makes you feel like it does.

BY ANY MEDIA NECESSARY *

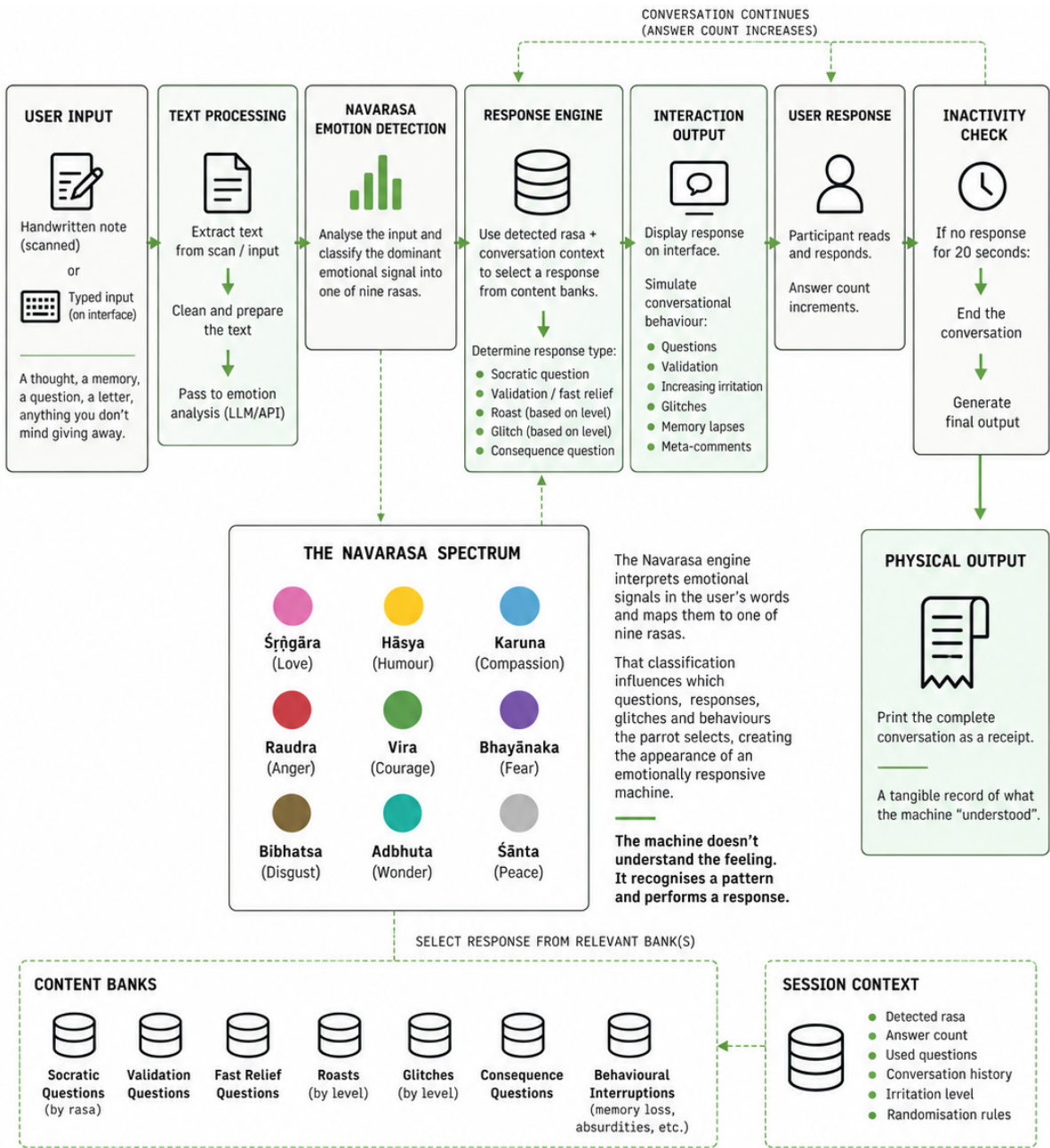
What happens when we outsource care to a machine? Does the machine become empathetic or execute the source code that simulates it?



Loneliness, social withdrawal, exclusion, acts of bullying, peer harm, feeling of invisibility due to exclusion from fellow humans and lack of awareness are the key reasons.

What happens when the feeling of being heard is easier to find in a machine than in a human being?

When did the idea of a fellow living, breathing, human being taking up space in our lives, become so obnoxious, that we felt easy when an AI did the same thing?



(Architecture diagram generated using AI)